

prehensive search built upon that server; a peer-to-peer foundation for communication; managed code to offer better security and code hygiene; and a vector-based graphical engine to display the OS on to the monitor.

Longhorn was slated to ship in 2003; the delay to its actual date would be one of the reasons for the derision it faced. The delay in question was set rolling at the end of 2001: this was when Windows XP faced the major UPnP vulnerability (the vulnerability could allow anyone to take over a target computer), and the fallout from that security flaw forced Microsoft to re-evaluate the very nature of the organisation and reshuffle resources internally—it was now decided that XP needed better armour against attacks before resources could be allocated to any successor. Of course, there were several other factors—the entire project had to be rebooted at least once, and Microsoft itself saw a drastic change in its structure with Windows veteran and Microsoft group vice president Jim Allchin declaring that Vista would be his last project within the halls of Microsoft.

Between XP and Vista, the company was determined to improve the security of its Windows OS—a welcome proposition to what was plagued by worms, viruses, malware, and buffer overflows. During the transition from intent to beta to the final build, many features were cut from Longhorn—the most infamous being the SQL-based file system called WinFS. Other major cuts included a new scripting shell codenamed Monad (now known as Power Shell), and a PC-to-PC synchronisation tool. Monad was removed for security reasons as it was deemed likely to open the consumer version of Vista to the same kind of hacks and exploits Microsoft was eager to leave behind. WinFS was removed just prior to the Longhorn reboot mentioned above—no solid reason was given for the feature-drop; many consider it to be a little too ambitious an undertaking. Features from WinFS were initially planned to make it to Vista post-release but even those plans were shelved. As things stand, components of WinFS are now slated to trickle into other MS products such as ADO.NET and Microsoft SQL Server. The syn-